

HP Omnibook 3

A thoughtful, everyday AI laptop

There's something reassuring about a laptop that doesn't try to be flashy, but quietly nails the essentials. The HP Omnibook 3 is one of those machines. It's not chasing RGB gimmicks or wafer-thin designs. Instead, it's built for students, remote workers, and anyone who wants a machine that works when it matters. And thanks to AMD's Ryzen AI platform and a polished build, the Omnibook 3 feels like a smart upgrade from your typical mid-range laptop.

But is it refined enough to stand out in the crowd of "AI laptops" flooding the market? I've been using the HP Omnibook 3 for a week now, and here's what stood out to me.

DESIGN, BUILD QUALITY, KEYBOARD & I/O

Visually, the Omnibook 3 sticks to a conservative but clean look. The Glacier Silver matte finish is fingerprint-resistant and minimalist, more executive chic than gamer flash. There's no flex on the keyboard deck and the overall footprint (1.86 cm thin and 1.7 kg) makes it easy to sling into a backpack.

HP has managed to strike a nice balance here. The lid opens with one hand, the build doesn't creak, and everything from the palm rest to the hinge feels mature, something often missing in laptops at this price point. It's not magnesium or aluminium, but the plastic here doesn't feel cheap.

The port selection is generous and well-distributed. You get:

- 1x USB-C (10Gbps, DisplayPort 1.4, Power Delivery)
- 2x USB-A (5Gbps)
- 1x HDMI 1.4b
- 1x headphone/mic combo
- 1x AC smart pin



It covers most daily use-cases, though a second USB-C would've made future-proofing sweeter. The keyboard is full-size, backlit, and comes with a number pad, which makes Excel warriors and typists happy. Travel is adequate, and the soft-grey keycap finish adds a touch of sophistication. The integrated fingerprint scanner on the deck is responsive and Windows Hello-ready. And the touchpad, it is smooth, accurate, and responsive. Nothing fancy, but no complaints.

DISPLAY & WEBCAM

The Omnibook 3's 15.6-inch FHD display doesn't try to dazzle, but it gets the job done. It's an anti-glare IPS panel with a standard 250 nits brightness and 62.5% sRGB colour gamut. Indoors, it's crisp enough for Netflix and Docs. Outdoors, you'll struggle under direct sunlight. That said, viewing angles could be better, and colours, while not punchy, are serviceable across the panel.

You're not buying this for colour grading or HDR video editing, but for everyday use, it's a comfortable, flicker-free experience, thanks to DC Dimming. Above the screen, HP has packed a 1080p True Vision camera with temporal noise reduction, dual microphones, and a physical privacy shutter. On Zoom and Google Meet, video looked crisp and lighting didn't blow out the highlights, even in mixed indoor lighting. Great webcam for its class.

AUDIO

HP went with a dual-speaker setup, and it sounds...fine. There's decent clarity in mids, and vocals sound clean in calls and YouTube videos.

But don't expect deep bass or immersive soundscapes here. It's just very flat.

If you listen to music while working, you'll want a pair of earbuds or external speakers.

BATTERY PERFORMANCE

Battery efficiency is where the Omnibook quietly wins. The 3-cell 41Wh battery supports fast charging, topping up 50% in about 45 minutes. While the actual battery life will depend on usage, so around 6–7 hours in balanced mode, enough for a lecture day or a work shift.

PERFORMANCE & BENCHMARKS

In terms of 3DMark Time Spy and Fire Strike benchmarks, the ASUS Vivobook S14 with the Intel Core Ultra 7 255H stands out as the top performer overall. It scores the highest in Time Spy with 2733 points and maintains a solid lead in Fire Strike with 4750 points, highlighting the efficiency of Intel's new integrated Arc graphics on Meteor Lake.

The HP Omnibook 3, powered by AMD's Ryzen AI 5 340, lands middle of the pack. With 1953 in Time Spy and 4559 in Fire Strike, it comfortably beats the ASUS ExpertBook P1 in Time Spy and closely trails it in Fire Strike. This suggests that AMD's RDNA3-based